

Vaccines & Pregnancy

Protecting you and your baby — before, during, and after pregnancy

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When you get vaccinated, you aren't just protecting yourself — your body makes **antibodies that cross the placenta** and give your baby early protection during the first months of life, before they are old enough for their own vaccines. Some vaccines are best given **before** pregnancy, three are recommended **during every pregnancy**, and a few are given **after delivery** to catch up.

BEFORE PREGNANCY (PRECONCEPTION)

The best time to get fully protected is before you conceive

- ✓ We **check your immunity** to measles, rubella & chickenpox (varicella)
- ✓ **MMR** and **varicella** are live vaccines — get them, then **wait 4 weeks** before trying to conceive
- ✓ **Flu shot** any time you may become pregnant
- ✓ Catch up on **HPV** vaccine through age 26
- ✓ **Hepatitis A & B** and **pneumococcal** if you have risk factors
- ✓ A preconception visit is the ideal time to **review your vaccine history**

DURING PREGNANCY — THREE VACCINES, EVERY PREGNANCY

Tdap
27–36 weeks · Every pregnancy

Protects against tetanus, diphtheria, and **pertussis (whooping cough)**. Whooping cough is especially dangerous for newborns — it can cause them to stop breathing and turn blue. Getting Tdap in the third trimester lets your antibodies cross the placenta and protect your baby from birth until their own vaccine at 2 months.

- ✓ Recommended in **EVERY** pregnancy
- ✓ Given at **27–36 weeks**
- ✓ Protects baby before their 2-month shots

Flu (Influenza)
Any trimester · Flu season

Pregnancy changes your immune, heart, and lung function, making you much more likely to become **seriously ill from the flu**. The flu also raises the risk of premature labor. The shot passes antibodies to your baby, protecting them before their own vaccine at 6 months.

- ✓ Safe in **any trimester**
- ✓ Get it by **end of October** if possible
- ✓ **Flu shot only** — not the nasal spray

RSV (Abrysvo)
32–36 weeks · Sept – Jan

RSV is the **leading cause of infant hospitalization** in the U.S. The Pfizer vaccine (Abrysvo) is the only RSV vaccine approved in pregnancy. Antibodies pass to your baby and protect against severe RSV for their first 6 months. **If you don't get the RSV vaccine, your baby can instead receive an antibody shot (nirsevimab) after birth.**

- ✓ Given at **32–36 weeks**
- ✓ Only during **Sept – Jan** (RSV season)
- ✓ Protects baby for first 6 months

VACCINE TIMING AT A GLANCE				
1st Trimester	2nd Trimester	3rd Trimester 27–36 wks	3rd Trimester 32–36 wks	Flu Season (any trimester)
Flu shot if season is active	Flu shot if season is active	Tdap every pregnancy	RSV (Abrysvo) Sept–Jan only	Flu shot by end of October

AFTER DELIVERY (POSTPARTUM)

Catch up on anything you couldn't get during pregnancy

- ✓ If you were **non-immune** to measles, rubella, or chickenpox, get those vaccines now
- ✓ These live vaccines are **safe while breastfeeding**
- ✓ Start or finish the **HPV** series if you're age 26 or younger
- ✓ Catch up on any **Hepatitis A/B** or **pneumococcal** doses you still need

⚠ Vaccines to AVOID during pregnancy

- **Live** vaccines are not given while pregnant: **MMR**, **varicella (chickenpox)**, and the **nasal-spray flu (FluMist)** — get these before or after pregnancy
- It's perfectly fine for your **family members** to receive these live vaccines
- If a live vaccine is given before a pregnancy is known, **don't worry** — no fetal harm has ever been reported

✓ Are these vaccines safe?

✓ Questions about vaccines?

Yes. The flu shot, Tdap, and RSV vaccine are studied extensively in pregnancy and recommended by **ACOG, the CDC, and the AAP**. The vaccines given during pregnancy are **not live** and cannot give you the disease. Side effects are mild and temporary — arm soreness, low-grade fever, or fatigue for 1–2 days — signs your immune system is responding. Vaccines do **not** cause autism or infertility.

Talk to us at your next visit. We're happy to **review your vaccination history** and make sure you and your baby are fully protected — before, during, and after pregnancy. No question is too small. You can also find reliable information at **[cdc.gov/vaccines](https://www.cdc.gov/vaccines)**.